The Guardian

one stop english

‘It’s a bit too castle-y’: plans to turn Cumbrian fortress into eco-attraction

Level 2: Intermediate – Teacher’s notes

Article summary: The article describes a family’s initiative to turn their castle into a carbon-zero ecotourist destination.

Time: 60 minutes

Skills: Reading, Speaking, Writing

Language focus: Phrasal verbs

Materials needed: One copy of the worksheet per student

1. Warmer

a. The purpose of this activity is to get students to think about travel and their own preferences. All of these countries are considered top ecotourism destinations. Make sure learners give reasons for their choice of destination. This can be continued in the *In Your Own Words* activity, where they can use the same destination to complete the task.

2. Key words

a. Ask students to do the exercise individually and then compare their answers in pairs or small groups. Students may be familiar with the word *attractive* to describe a beautiful person, but in the article, it means ‘something that is interesting which grabs your attention.’

Key:

1. *solar*
2. *Energy*
3. *eco-friendly*
4. *attractive*
5. *remote*
6. *challenges*
7. *valuable*
8. *Tourism*
9. *prediction*
10. *ruin*
11. *underground*
12. *ancestors*

b. Before reading the article carefully, students use some of the key words to fill the gaps in the sentences to ensure that they understand their meanings and usage.

Key:

1. *remote*
2. *eco-friendly*
3. *challenges*
4. *predictions*

3. Comprehension check

a. The answers given are only suggested answers, and students may correctly answer the questions in different ways, e.g., in item 1, they may say, ‘The castle is in the UK’ or similar.

Key:

1. *northwest England*
2. *black bears*
3. *a solar farm*
4. *800 years old*
5. *make Muncaster the first carbon-zero castle in the UK*
6. *San Francisco*
7. *his parents*
8. *hills and mountains*
9. *about £10,000*
10. *a Venetian glass bowl from Henry VI*

4. Key language

a. Students could be asked to do this exercise individually and then compare their answers in pairs. The phrasal verbs are all used in the text. As an extension activity, ask students to find them and then make sentences of their own.

Key:

1. *g*
2. *d*
3. *f*
4. *a*
5. *b*
6. *h*
7. *e*
8. *c*

5. Discussion

a. Allow students time to note down their ideas about each statement and encourage them to say why they agree or disagree with each one.

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6. In your own words

a. Have students use a search engine to find more information about ecotourism. Ask them to find some top locations for ecotourism holidays and what you can do in those places. Students could use one of the locations from the Warmer exercise if they wish.

b. Students could then present their reports to the class.

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